

Michael Senkow

Staff Product Designer | UX for AI Tools, Research & Design Systems

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UX designer for AI-powered and internal tools: research to product design to visual/brand systems to front-end contribution. Prior Meta Staff PD on cross-pillar data/AI workflows; also Microsoft, IBM, Apple.

Comfortable as a shared design resource -- running feedback sessions and usability tests, shipping Figma specs/prototypes, owning visual cohesion, and codifying patterns so teams ship on-brand without a designer in every loop.

Design-to-code fluency (Figma, React/TS, Storybook) for marketing surfaces, brand artifacts, and lightweight web experiences alongside core product work.

EXPERIENCE

Sleeping Ox Studios -- Seattle, WA (Remote / Hybrid)

11/2023 - Present

Staff Product Designer (Consulting) -- AI products, design systems, brand & front-end

- Legal AI platform: led end-to-end UX across a dual-brand legal + enterprise AI product -- research-informed flows, Figma systems, and production React/CSS for scalable UI.
- HR AI product: designed private-data conversational patterns (next-step guidance, history) and tested AI interaction models to reduce adoption friction for white-collar workflows.
- Corporate Data Suite: built a Figma design system unifying product + marketing brand identity; documented patterns for rapid, consistent iteration across teams.
- i2Systems: shipped Storybook/component framework with interaction demos -- standards that let engineers build on-brand experiences with less designer bottleneck.
- Front-end contribution: responsive UI, accessibility, and lightweight coded polish across web/mobile; established reusable visual/interaction standards for marketing and brand surfaces.

Meta -- Seattle, WA (Remote / Hybrid)

11/2020 - 11/2023

Staff Product Designer -- internal AI / data tools, design systems, research enablement

- Shared design resource across internal analysis products (dashboards, notebooks, data prep) -- raised design quality and reduced friction for Meta employees' problem-solving workflows.
- Owned improvements to the Data Visualization Design System (XDS): components, patterns, and standards so product teams could ship coherent experiences at scale.
- Ran and presented at research events and internal forums; turned structured feedback and usability insights into prioritized recommendations across a portfolio of tools.
- Designed LLM / natural-language workflows for visualization and AI-driven insight discovery; delivered Figma wireframes, hi-fi prototypes, and coded examples with XFN partners.
- Unified notebook UX across product spaces -- interaction consistency, documentation, and design reviews that helped builders ship without reinventing patterns.

Microsoft -- Seattle, WA

02/2017 - 11/2020

Senior Product Designer -- Microsoft 365 analytics, design systems, prototyping

- End-to-end product design for analytics across Microsoft 365 (Office, Teams) -- specs, wireframes, hi-fi mockups, and prototypes that drove stakeholder alignment.
- Built design system + style guide for MyAnalytics / Workplace Analytics (later Viva Insights); documented standards for cross-product visual and interaction consistency.
- Partnered with PMs and engineers to prioritize by impact across concurrent requests; shipped Teams admin portal features improving org visibility and workflows.
- Enabled design quality at scale: mentored/onboarded designers, ran reviews, and championed research + craft via hackathons, conferences, and onboarding programs.

IBM -- Austin, TX

03/2013 - 02/2017

Product Designer / Front-End Developer -- Watson AI, Carbon design system

- Co-led early Carbon Blue design system: foundational components, style guidance, and adoption patterns across IBM's product suite (design system from near-scratch).
- Designed AI/ML and data products (Watson Data Platform, Watson Analytics, Cognos BI) -- research through launch with product and engineering partners.
- Contributed front-end implementation alongside design; helped scale UX practice in IBM's enterprise design transformation (designer:engineer leverage).

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Apple -- Cupertino, CA

04/2012 - 08/2012

- UX Researcher & Designer (Internal Services): prototyped internal tools (room reservation, App Store concepts, accessibility); partnered with senior researchers/designers on early-stage validation.

University of Michigan -- Research Assistant

05/2011 - 05/2013

- HCI + spatial computing research: prototyping, interactive demos, and cross-disciplinary studies bridging Information Science and Architecture.

EDUCATION

MS, Information Science -- Human-Computer Interaction -- University of Michigan

2012 - 2013

MS coursework, Architecture / Digital Fabrication -- University of Michigan

2011 - 2012

BS, Mechanical Engineering & Technical Communication (dual) -- Michigan Technological University

2004 - 2009

Speaking: ConveyUX 2017; Frontporch.io 2016 (Enterprise Design Guides); SXSW 2014. Patent contributor: US20190259298A1 (behavior change management).

CORE SKILLS

Figma (specs, prototyping, design systems) | Design Research & Usability Testing | AI / Agent UX | Internal Tools & B2B | Visual Identity & Brand Systems | Design Systems & Documentation | Wireframes / Hi-fi / Interactive Prototypes | Front-end (React/TS, Storybook, CSS) | Accessibility | Research Ops |